Adam Hickey

Senior Product Designer · Design Systems · Prototyping in Code · Usability Testing · Complex Workflows

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Professional summary

Senior product designer with 20 years across visual design, interactive experiences and enterprise software, for organizations including Cargill, Intel, CBRE and Toro. I design software that fits the job and earns the trust of the person doing it. I began as a hybrid interactive designer and developer, building what I designed in HTML, CSS and jQuery; spent thirteen years leading enterprise product design and design systems at scale; and now design the system people and coding agents build from, and decide what ships.

Experience

Selected Independent Work — Product design, visual systems, prototyping 2026 – Present

- **Agent Review** — Designed and built, with Claude Code, a React and TypeScript prototype where agents build the screens and a designer decides what ships: a component system with written design rules and automated visual and accessibility checks, following one feature from a support ticket to release.
- **Dispatch Cockpit** — Designed a decision-support prototype for AI-assisted load assignment, making evidence, confidence, overrides and the manual path visible to expert dispatchers.
- **Door County Found** and **Lucy Learns** — two products in use, designed and built end to end: an editorial travel guide (identity, art direction, a site its editor keeps current) and an illustrated, offline-first dog-training app.

RBA Inc — Lead UX Product Designer 2013 – 2026

- Led UX and visual design for complex digital products, enterprise applications and design systems for clients in logistics, manufacturing, healthcare, financial services and the public sector, including compliance-sensitive work for a federal agency, a regional bank and healthcare providers.
- Sat with people through their workday and fixed what slowed them: usability testing on real tasks, information architecture, interaction design and visual hierarchy across large sets of screens, with developers in the room from the first sketch.
- Built and governed design systems across SAP, Microsoft, Umbraco, and Sitecore platforms: tokens, component libraries, contribution rules and release checkpoints; designed and built Connect, the firm's own design-system site. Led the accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA), DesignOps and governance practices.
- Tied design decisions to the numbers teams already track: efficiency, adoption, quality, ROI.

Pixel Farm — Interactive Designer / Developer Jan 2008 – Apr 2013

Designed and built brand-led websites, campaigns and interactive pieces for Lund Boats, Fulton Beer, Hazelden and others, including Lund's boat configurator; shipped two native iOS apps and an iPad app; led rebrands and identity systems. Front ends in HTML, CSS and jQuery.

LEVEL — Interactive Designer Jan 2006 – Jan 2008

Designed and built websites and interactive pieces in HTML, CSS and Flash, beside writers, creative leads and developers.

ByDesign — Design Intern 2004 – 2006

Selected projects

- Making 40+ SAP applications feel like one product: one visual language, one design system and one accessibility standard, about a third less time from design to development, and UI defects in production cut roughly in half.
- An identity, illustration and badge system, templates and a community platform for a global corporation's innovation network, over four fiscal years; campaign production time roughly halved.
- Replacing spreadsheets with one USDA grant-management portal, cutting data-analysis requests from 45–55 hours to just over 10.
- A real-time cockpit for a 450+ truck fleet, built for the speed of expert dispatchers; board-clearing time down roughly 30%.

Core capabilities

UX & Interface Design · Visual Design & Typography · Complex Workflows · Information Architecture · Interaction Design · Design Systems & Governance · Accessibility (WCAG 2.1 AA) · Brand Identity & Illustration · Prototyping in Code · Usability Testing · Human–AI Interaction · Developer Collaboration

Tools & platforms

Design: Figma/FigJam (variables, Dev Mode, component libraries) · Adobe Creative Cloud (Illustrator, Photoshop, InDesign) · CSS custom properties (tokens) · ChatGPT & Gemini
Front end, by hand (2005–2013) and with coding agents now: HTML · CSS · JavaScript/jQuery · React · TypeScript · Storybook · Playwright · Vitest & axe · Git/GitHub · Claude Code (skills, plugins, MCP)
Platforms: SAP Fiori · Sitecore · Umbraco · WordPress · Joomla! · WCAG 2.1 AA

Education

Bachelor of Science in Graphic Design, University of Minnesota–Twin Cities (2005)